WINDOWS SERVER - PRINTABLE TASK CHECKLIST

246 separate tasks | Tick a square for each completed inspection, fix or verification

Round/date: _____ Team: _____

Image: _____ Starting score: _____ Final: _____

Write N/A beside items that do not apply. See full platform guide before changes.

01. Identify Server version, role and access

- ☐ **S001** Read complete image README, role notes and forensics instructions N/A
- ☐ **S002** Record Windows Server version and build N/A
- ☐ **S003** Identify Desktop Experience or Server Core N/A
- ☐ **S004** Check whether this machine is standalone, domain member or Domain Controller N/A
- ☐ **S005** Confirm actual ProductType and DomainRole N/A
- ☐ **S006** Check whether AD DS binaries are installed N/A
- ☐ **S007** Confirm if the server is actually promoted as a DC N/A
- ☐ **S008** Record domain and computer name N/A
- ☐ **S009** Inventory installed Windows Server roles and features N/A
- ☐ **S010** Record required directory, DNS, DHCP, IIS, FTP and SMB roles N/A
- ☐ **S011** Record approved remote management methods N/A
- ☐ **S012** Confirm authorized administrator or console access N/A
- ☐ **S013** Record initial scoring report timestamp and points N/A
- ☐ **S014** Identify authorized snapshot or recovery option N/A
- ☐ **S015** Open elevated PowerShell and Server Manager when available N/A

Notes / exceptions: _____

02. Forensics and role-aware backups

- ☐ **S016** Find each Forensics Question file and required answer format N/A
- ☐ **S017** Preserve evidence before account or software cleanup N/A
- ☐ **S018** Inspect relevant System and Security event logs N/A
- ☐ **S019** Inspect role-specific Directory Service/DNS/DHCP events if present N/A
- ☐ **S020** Identify suspicious executable and record its hash if required N/A

- [ ] **S021** Record scheduled-task and service evidence before disabling N/A
- [ ] **S022** Save every forensic answer in the original file N/A
- [ ] **S023** Record original account and group memberships before edits N/A
- [ ] **S024** Record current local security and GPO settings N/A
- [ ] **S025** Record original firewall rules and relevant source scopes N/A
- [ ] **S026** Record critical role configuration and recovery location N/A
- [ ] **S027** Create an approved snapshot/backup only if rules permit N/A
- [ ] **S028** Verify a second authorized administrative login works N/A
- [ ] **S029** Maintain a private change log with old/new values N/A

Notes / exceptions: _____

03. Standalone and domain member local accounts

- [ ] **S030** Determine whether local SAM user tools apply N/A
- [ ] **S031** List local accounts with Get-LocalUser when applicable N/A
- [ ] **S032** Compare all local human users to README list N/A
- [ ] **S033** Check built-in Guest state and required exceptions N/A
- [ ] **S034** Check built-in Administrator recovery requirements N/A
- [ ] **S035** Inspect local Administrators group N/A
- [ ] **S036** Inspect local Remote Desktop Users group N/A
- [ ] **S037** Inspect local Backup Operators group N/A
- [ ] **S038** Check required domain-group membership in local groups N/A
- [ ] **S039** Check unauthorized local user Enabled state N/A
- [ ] **S040** Check PasswordRequired and PasswordNeverExpires N/A
- [ ] **S041** Disable a confirmed unauthorized local user after evidence preservation N/A
- [ ] **S042** Remove only confirmed unauthorized admin membership N/A
- [ ] **S043** Restore any missing authorized local administrator N/A
- [ ] **S044** Test permitted local login and admin elevation N/A
- [ ] **S045** Do not use local SAM cmdlets for DC domain users N/A

Notes / exceptions: _____

04. Domain accounts, privileged groups and service users

- [ ] **S046** Confirm ActiveDirectory module availability and permissions N/A
- [ ] **S047** Open ADUC and enable Advanced Features if DC/AD tools exist N/A
- [ ] **S048** Inventory domain human users across all OUs N/A
- [ ] **S049** Identify domain service accounts and managed service accounts N/A
- [ ] **S050** Preserve krbtgt and computer objects N/A
- [ ] **S051** Inspect built-in domain Administrator account N/A
- [ ] **S052** Review Domain Admins direct membership N/A
- [ ] **S053** Review Domain Admins nested membership N/A
- [ ] **S054** Review Enterprise Admins membership if applicable N/A
- [ ] **S055** Review Schema Admins membership if applicable N/A
- [ ] **S056** Review Builtin Administrators membership N/A
- [ ] **S057** Review Account Operators and Backup Operators N/A
- [ ] **S058** Review Server Operators and Print Operators where present N/A
- [ ] **S059** Review DnsAdmins and Group Policy Creator Owners N/A
- [ ] **S060** Inspect users with PasswordNeverExpires N/A
- [ ] **S061** Inspect users with PasswordNotRequired N/A
- [ ] **S062** Inspect users lacking required Kerberos preauthentication N/A
- [ ] **S063** Inspect risky account delegation only when assigned N/A
- [ ] **S064** Disable only a confirmed unauthorized domain login N/A
- [ ] **S065** Remove only a confirmed unauthorized privileged-group member N/A
- [ ] **S066** Verify group membership and a legitimate domain login N/A
- [ ] **S067** Check that needed service accounts still run tasks and apps N/A

Notes / exceptions: _____

05. Local and domain password/account policies

- [ ] **S068** Record net accounts output for local-account scope N/A
- [ ] **S069** Identify effective domain password policy owner N/A
- [ ] **S070** Check password minimum length requirement N/A
- [ ] **S071** Check password history count N/A

- [ ] **S072** Check password maximum and minimum age N/A
- [ ] **S073** Check password complexity policy N/A
- [ ] **S074** Check reversible encryption policy N/A
- [ ] **S075** Check account lockout threshold N/A
- [ ] **S076** Check lockout duration N/A
- [ ] **S077** Check reset-counter observation period N/A
- [ ] **S078** Inspect Default Domain Policy at the correct domain scope N/A
- [ ] **S079** Check Domain Controllers OU linked GPOs N/A
- [ ] **S080** Inspect fine-grained password policies if AD is present N/A
- [ ] **S081** Inspect resultant password policy for a representative account N/A
- [ ] **S082** Back up specific GPO before changes N/A
- [ ] **S083** Change only values explicitly required by the README N/A
- [ ] **S084** Verify final effective account policy and allowed logon N/A
- [ ] **S085** Restore only incorrectly changed policy values if needed N/A

Notes / exceptions: _____

06. Defender, security updates and baseline

- [ ] **S086** Identify active antivirus provider and any passive Defender state N/A
- [ ] **S087** Check Windows Defender Antivirus feature when applicable N/A
- [ ] **S088** Check Defender real-time protection N/A
- [ ] **S089** Check behavior and script monitoring N/A
- [ ] **S090** Check Defender signature version and freshness N/A
- [ ] **S091** Inspect Defender path exclusions N/A
- [ ] **S092** Inspect process and extension exclusions N/A
- [ ] **S093** Compare exclusions to required server workloads N/A
- [ ] **S094** Apply approved signature update if required N/A
- [ ] **S095** Scan only when forensics are preserved and workload permits N/A
- [ ] **S096** Inspect Windows Update and WSUS policy N/A
- [ ] **S097** Inspect approved installed security updates N/A
- [ ] **S098** Check pending/reboot-needed updates N/A
- [ ] **S099** Apply permitted updates without a forced release upgrade N/A
- [ ] **S100** Verify DNS/AD/IIS/database/other required roles after updates N/A

Notes / exceptions: _____

07. Server firewall and management access

☐	**S101**	Identify active Domain/Private/Public firewall profile	N/A
☐	**S102**	Check each firewall profile Enabled state	N/A
☐	**S103**	Inspect default inbound and outbound actions	N/A
☐	**S104**	Inventory effective inbound allow rules	N/A
☐	**S105**	Check AD DS, Kerberos, LDAP, RPC rules if DC	N/A
☐	**S106**	Check required DNS rules	N/A
☐	**S107**	Check required DHCP rules	N/A
☐	**S108**	Check required IIS web/FTP rules	N/A
☐	**S109**	Check required SMB/file-server rules	N/A
☐	**S110**	Check authorized RDP rule and source scope	N/A
☐	**S111**	Check authorized WinRM rule and source scope	N/A
☐	**S112**	List listening TCP and UDP services	N/A
☐	**S113**	Record original firewall settings before edits	N/A
☐	**S114**	Disable only confirmed unauthorized rule(s)	N/A
☐	**S115**	Test each required network service from an authorized client	N/A
☐	**S116**	Verify effective firewall profile and rule state	N/A
☐	**S117**	Restore a specific changed rule if service access breaks	N/A

Notes / exceptions: _____

08. Group Policy, auditing and LDAP

☐	**S118**	Inventory applicable GPO links and precedence	N/A
☐	**S119**	Check whether the server is DC, member or standalone	N/A
☐	**S120**	Inspect local audit policy when applicable	N/A
☐	**S121**	Inspect account logon auditing	N/A
☐	**S122**	Inspect account management auditing	N/A
☐	**S123**	Inspect security logon/logoff auditing	N/A
☐	**S124**	Inspect policy change auditing	N/A
☐	**S125**	Inspect process creation auditing when required	N/A

- [ ] **S126** Inspect User Rights Assignment at correct policy scope N/A
- [ ] **S127** Check Deny logon rights for unintended groups N/A
- [ ] **S128** Check network logon rights needed by DC clients N/A
- [ ] **S129** Back up the specific GPO before editing N/A
- [ ] **S130** Inspect LDAP signing current policy N/A
- [ ] **S131** Review Directory Service LDAP unsigned-bind events N/A
- [ ] **S132** Check legacy LDAP client compatibility before enforcement N/A
- [ ] **S133** Inspect LDAP channel-binding policy and compatibility N/A
- [ ] **S134** Check insecure Netlogon exception settings when applicable N/A
- [ ] **S135** Verify applied GPO and authorized domain client logon N/A
- [ ] **S136** Restore one scoped policy if services break N/A

Notes / exceptions: _____

09. Domain Controller and DNS health

- [ ] **S137** Confirm NTDS role and service health if this is a DC N/A
- [ ] **S138** Check KDC and Netlogon operational state N/A
- [ ] **S139** Check DNS role and service health when required N/A
- [ ] **S140** Check W32Time/domain clock status N/A
- [ ] **S141** Check SYSVOL and NETLOGON shares remain accessible N/A
- [ ] **S142** Check DFS replication health when applicable N/A
- [ ] **S143** Run dcdiag on appropriate DC if needed N/A
- [ ] **S144** Review replication summary if multiple DCs are present N/A
- [ ] **S145** Check domain DNS SRV records N/A
- [ ] **S146** Inspect DNS server zone list N/A
- [ ] **S147** Identify AD-integrated zones where relevant N/A
- [ ] **S148** Inspect secure dynamic update policy N/A
- [ ] **S149** Inspect DNS zone transfers and approved secondary servers N/A
- [ ] **S150** Inspect suspicious/unknown records without bulk deletion N/A
- [ ] **S151** Check DNS forwarders against authorized network design N/A
- [ ] **S152** Verify required host and SRV name resolution from a client N/A
- [ ] **S153** Verify permitted dynamic update or secondary transfer N/A
- [ ] **S154** Restore only a changed DNS zone/record setting if required N/A

Notes / exceptions: _____

10. DHCP server configuration and clients

☐	**S155**	Verify DHCP server role is installed only if required	N/A
☐	**S156**	Inspect DHCP authorization in domain if applicable	N/A
☐	**S157**	Record all active IPv4 scopes	N/A
☐	**S158**	Inspect start/end ranges and subnet masks	N/A
☐	**S159**	Inspect excluded address ranges	N/A
☐	**S160**	Inspect reservations and device MAC mappings	N/A
☐	**S161**	Inspect scope Option 003 router	N/A
☐	**S162**	Inspect scope Option 006 DNS servers	N/A
☐	**S163**	Inspect scope Option 015 DNS domain	N/A
☐	**S164**	Inspect failover pairing if configured	N/A
☐	**S165**	Review lease utilization and conflicting addresses	N/A
☐	**S166**	Check DHCP audit logging policy	N/A
☐	**S167**	Back up DHCP role configuration before editing	N/A
☐	**S168**	Change only an unauthorized scope/option/reservation	N/A
☐	**S169**	Renew or inspect a noncritical approved client lease	N/A
☐	**S170**	Verify client address, gateway and DNS settings	N/A
☐	**S171**	Restore the exact prior DHCP option/reservation if wrong	N/A

Notes / exceptions: _____

11. IIS and FTP if the server requires them

☐	**S172**	Confirm IIS web role and required site list	N/A
☐	**S173**	Record IIS site bindings and hostname/port	N/A
☐	**S174**	Record IIS content directories and application data	N/A
☐	**S175**	Back up IIS configuration before edits	N/A
☐	**S176**	Check web server directory browsing policy	N/A
☐	**S177**	Check basic/anonymous authentication requirements	N/A
☐	**S178**	Check request filtering and extension rules	N/A
☐	**S179**	Check response header/version disclosure settings	N/A

- ☐ **S180** Check WebDAV if installed N/A
- ☐ **S181** Check IIS logging configuration N/A
- ☐ **S182** Check app pool identities and least privilege N/A
- ☐ **S183** Inspect suspicious web files without executing them N/A
- ☐ **S184** Check IIS certificate/TLS requirements N/A
- ☐ **S185** Test required website via actual hostname and port N/A
- ☐ **S186** Test application login/API and database connections N/A
- ☐ **S187** Inspect required FTP site if installed N/A
- ☐ **S188** Check FTP authentication and user authorization N/A
- ☐ **S189** Check FTP passive data ports and firewall support N/A
- ☐ **S190** Test permitted FTP login and file transfer N/A
- ☐ **S191** Restore only a changed IIS/FTP setting if needed N/A

Notes / exceptions: _____

12. SMB, roles, services and print spooler

- ☐ **S192** List all SMB shares including special administrative shares N/A
- ☐ **S193** Preserve required SYSVOL and NETLOGON on DCs N/A
- ☐ **S194** Inspect authorized custom share paths N/A
- ☐ **S195** Inspect share-level permission entries N/A
- ☐ **S196** Inspect NTFS ACLs for required share folders N/A
- ☐ **S197** Check SMB1 server compatibility and installed state N/A
- ☐ **S198** Check SMB signing requirement and authorized clients N/A
- ☐ **S199** Test share read/write as a permitted ordinary user N/A
- ☐ **S200** Test denied share access for a disallowed user when approved N/A
- ☐ **S201** Inventory installed roles and features N/A
- ☐ **S202** Review legacy Telnet/TFTP/SNMP/SMB1/PowerShell2 features N/A
- ☐ **S203** Preview any role removal one feature at a time N/A
- ☐ **S204** Never remove AD DS/DNS/DHCP/IIS required by README N/A
- ☐ **S205** Inventory running and startup-configured services N/A
- ☐ **S206** Identify unexpected service executable paths N/A
- ☐ **S207** Inspect Print Spooler requirement and print-server role N/A
- ☐ **S208** Inspect Point and Print driver installation restrictions N/A

- [ ] **S209** Keep WinRM/management functionality if required N/A
- [ ] **S210** Disable only a confirmed unneeded service N/A
- [ ] **S211** Verify all required roles still work after changes N/A

Notes / exceptions: _____

13. Remote access, persistence and miscellaneous

- [ ] **S212** Check RDP allowed/denied state N/A
- [ ] **S213** Check Network Level Authentication when RDP is required N/A
- [ ] **S214** Check RDP authorization groups or DC logon rights N/A
- [ ] **S215** Check Remote Assistance only if installed/relevant N/A
- [ ] **S216** Inspect WinRM authentication and encryption policies N/A
- [ ] **S217** Inspect WinRM listeners and management firewall rules N/A
- [ ] **S218** Inspect installed remote-control applications N/A
- [ ] **S219** Inspect startup registry Run entries N/A
- [ ] **S220** Inspect scheduled tasks and task actions N/A
- [ ] **S221** Inspect service Log On As accounts N/A
- [ ] **S222** Inspect new services with unexpected executable paths N/A
- [ ] **S223** Inspect unknown inbound listening ports N/A
- [ ] **S224** Inspect file hashes/signatures of suspicious executables N/A
- [ ] **S225** Check required backup/scheduled tasks are preserved N/A
- [ ] **S226** Check UAC and relevant Security Options N/A
- [ ] **S227** Check browser updates if server browser access is required N/A
- [ ] **S228** Preserve event logs and forensic evidence N/A
- [ ] **S229** Restore specific unauthorized or mistakenly changed items N/A

Notes / exceptions: _____

14. Final server-role validation

- [ ] **S230** Verify all forensic answers saved and complete N/A
- [ ] **S231** Verify correct standalone/member/DC role N/A
- [ ] **S232** Verify authorized local and domain administrators N/A
- [ ] **S233** Verify correct effective password and lockout policies N/A

- ☐ **S234** Verify Defender and current approved updates N/A
- ☐ **S235** Verify applicable firewall profiles and required exceptions N/A
- ☐ **S236** Verify fresh authorized local/domain logon N/A
- ☐ **S237** Verify AD, DNS, Netlogon, time and replication if DC N/A
- ☐ **S238** Verify DHCP client obtains required configuration N/A
- ☐ **S239** Verify IIS/FTP required client transactions N/A
- ☐ **S240** Verify required SMB sharing and NTFS access N/A
- ☐ **S241** Verify authorized RDP/WinRM access if required N/A
- ☐ **S242** Verify unnecessary services/roles remain disabled or removed safely N/A
- ☐ **S243** Verify no unauthorized accounts or persistence remain N/A
- ☐ **S244** Refresh official scoring report and record final value N/A
- ☐ **S245** Record any N/A tasks with supporting rationale N/A
- ☐ **S246** Save rollback notes and finish without unplanned reboot N/A

Notes / exceptions: _____

FINAL REVIEW - required services tested / exceptions / reviewer:

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